



▲ TWO-HANDED SWORD

Date 1550

Origin Germany

Weight 3.18kg (7lb)

Length 1.4m (4½ft)

These swords were popular in Germany, particularly with those defending the company banner. They were carried on the shoulder. When used at close quarters, the grip could be shortened by grasping the base of the blade, the lugs protecting the hand.

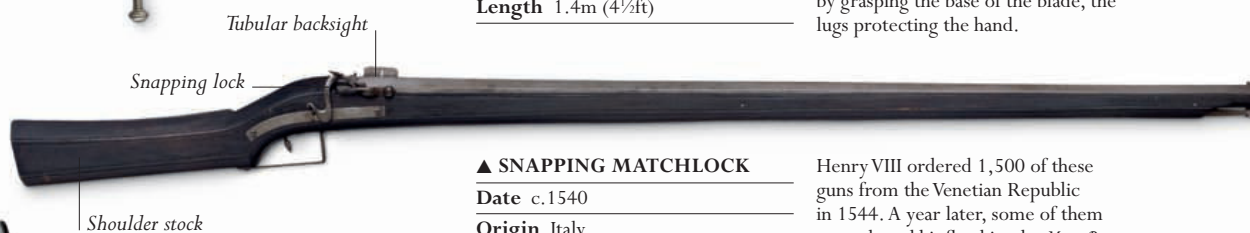
▼ MUNITION ARMOUR

Date c.1560

Origin Germany

Material Iron, leather

Infantry armours were a staple product of the German armour-producing centres. They were made in different configurations and qualities to suit the clients' needs. Many, such as this example, were decorated with polished bands, the remaining surface being left black from the hammer.



▲ SNAPPING MATCHLOCK

Date c.1540

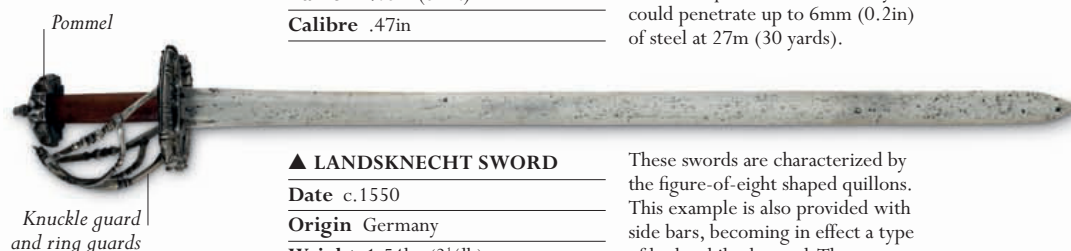
Origin Italy

Weight 3.5kg (7¾lb)

Barrel 1.05m (3½ft)

Calibre .47in

Henry VIII ordered 1,500 of these guns from the Venetian Republic in 1544. A year later, some of them were aboard his flagship, the *Mary Rose*, when it sank. Experiments with a modern replica showed that they could penetrate up to 6mm (0.2in) of steel at 27m (30 yards).



▲ LANDSKNECHT SWORD

Date c.1550

Origin Germany

Weight 1.54kg (3½lb)

Length 96cm (37¼in)

These swords are characterized by the figure-of-eight shaped quillons. This example is also provided with side bars, becoming in effect a type of basket-hilted sword. They were widely used by the infantry of Germany and northern Italy.



▲ LANDSKNECHT DAGGER

Date c.1520

Origin Germany

Weight 330g (11¼oz)

Length 31cm (12¼in)

These simple weapons, in use over much of Europe, were invaluable in hand-to-hand fighting. Most had double-edged blades with a flattened diamond-shape in cross-section. Blades were to become slimmer as the century progressed.



◀ BURGONET

Date c.1570

Origin Germany

Material Iron, leather

This burgonet with its roped comb and embossed leaf decoration must have formed part of a superior armour. It differs from those of munition quality in having articulating lames for the rear gorget plate and a pivoted peak or fall.

► COMB MORION

Date c.1580

Origin Italy

Material Iron, leather

The comb morion eventually developed into the pikeman's pot. Early examples have the comb, skull, and brim forged in one piece, while later examples were made in two halves. The earpieces on this example are missing.

